



Throne of Titans

Sid Meier's Civilization IV: Beyond the Sword

Modlist & Game Guide — Patch 3.19

Four waves — from first settler to the Throne of Titans

Mods organized with the CIV 4 — All Mod Chooser

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1 Installation

Everything you need to run *Beyond the Sword* 3.19 with mods — via the *CIV 4 – All Mod Chooser*, with a full manual fallback.

1.1 Prerequisites

- A working install of *Sid Meier's Civilization IV: Beyond the Sword* (Steam, GOG, or retail disc).
- The game patched to **3.19** — Steam and GOG versions already ship at 3.19; retail discs need the official 3.19 patch.
- Enough free space for the mods you install (total conversions can be large).

1.2 Check the version (3.19)

The main menu displays the current game version. If it is anything other than 3.19, apply the official 3.19 patch before installing any mods — most modern mods assume it.

1.3 Find the right folders

- Steam: ...\\Steam\\steamapps\\common\\Sid Meier's Civilization IV Beyond the Sword\\Beyond the Sword\\
- Retail / GOG Complete: ...\\Sid Meier's Civilization 4 Complete\\Beyond the Sword\\ (path varies by install)

All mods live in the **Mods** subfolder: <BTS>\\Mods\\. On Steam, mind the nested Beyond the Sword folder — the Mods folder is **inside** it, not in the app root.

1.4 Method A — CIV 4 – All Mod Chooser (recommended)

Good to know

The All Mod Chooser is a community launcher for Civ 4. It manages all game variants (Vanilla, Warlords, Beyond the Sword, Colonization), detects installed mods, and starts the game with the correct launch parameters — no shortcut editing. Recent versions (v2.9 and newer) also handle custom resolutions and windowed mode, which helps on modern displays.

1.4.1 Download

- Get the current release from the CivFanatics forums: Civ4 → **Creation & Customization** → thread “*Tool - CIV 4 - All Mod Chooser 2025*” (the thread is updated with new versions; v2.9 is a recent reference).
- Mirror: civforum.de — Civ4 downloads area, maintained by *onkelm*.
- Extract the archive to a permanent location, e.g. C:\\Tools\\Civ4ModChooser\\.

1.4.2 First-run configuration

1. Start the tool.
2. Point it at your **main Civilization IV installation folder** — the folder that contains the separate game directories (the “Civilization IV Complete” root, or the Steam BTS app root). The chooser needs this to find the Vanilla / Warlords / Beyond the Sword trees.
3. Verify it lists **Beyond the Sword** and the mods present in <BTS>\\Mods\\.

1.4.3 Launching a mod

1. Select **Beyond the Sword** as the game variant.
 2. Pick the desired mod from the list.
 3. Launch — the game starts with the right mod= parameter and loads straight into the mod.
- To play without a mod, choose “None”. Switching between mods is just a relaunch through the chooser.

1.4.4 Notes

- If a mod is missing from the list, re-check the path from “First-run configuration” and confirm the mod is installed as in Method B step 1.
- Resolution and windowed-mode options live in the chooser’s settings (v2.9+).

1.5 Method B — Manual installation (fallback)

1.5.1 Install a mod

1. Download the mod archive (.zip, .rar, or .7z).
2. Extract it so the mod folder lands inside <BTS>\Mods\. The result must look like <BTS>\Mods\ModName\Assets\... — an Assets folder dumped directly into Mods is **not** recognized.
3. Read the mod's readme: complex mods sometimes need extra steps.

1.5.2 Load a mod

- **In-game:** main menu → **Advanced** → **Load a Mod** → choose the mod → the game restarts with it.
- **Desktop shortcut:** copy a shortcut to Civilization4BeyondSword.exe and append mod=\ModName to the Target field, e.g. "C:\...\Beyond the Sword\Civilization4BeyondSword.exe" mod=\ModName.
- **Steam:** right-click the game → Properties → General → Launch Options → mod=\ModName.

1.5.3 Back to vanilla

Use **Load a Mod** and pick “None”, remove the mod= argument from the shortcut or launch options, or just start the game normally.

1.6 Troubleshooting

- **Mod missing from the load list** — wrong folder structure (see “Install a mod”), or you edited the wrong Mods folder (see “Find the right folders”).
- **Crash when loading a mod** — many total conversions ship their own DLL and require exactly BTS 3.19; confirm the game version (see “Check the version”) and the mod's own requirements.
- **Display problems on modern monitors** — use the chooser's custom resolution / windowed mode (v2.9+), the game's own graphics settings, or the **Playing at 4K** section below.
- **Steam nested folders** — double-check that your Mods folder is <app root>\Beyond the Sword\Mods, not the app root itself.

1.7 Playing at 4K: fonts and readability

Civ 4's interface was designed for mid-2000s monitors: the UI art (buttons, panels, icons) is fixed-size bitmap graphics that do not scale with resolution, so at 4K the text becomes very small. There is no UI-scale option in the game, and no packaged mod fixes this — but the fonts can be enlarged by hand. Everything in this section is game configuration, not a mod, and does not affect the mod list.

1.7.1 Windows High-DPI override (fastest to try)

1. Right-click Civ4BeyondSword.exe (in the <BTS>\ folder) → **Properties** → **Compatibility**.
2. Click **Change high DPI settings** (or tick **Override high DPI scaling behavior**).
3. Tick **Override high DPI scaling behavior** and choose **System** (or **System (Enhanced)** when available).
4. Apply, then relaunch the game.

Good to know

If the game then renders only part of the screen or the mouse misbehaves, run it in **Windowed Mode** — via the graphics options, or by setting `FullScreen = 0` in CivilizationIV.ini under Documents\My Games\Beyond the Sword.

1.7.2 Larger fonts via the theme file

1. Back up <BTS>\Resource\Themes\Civ4\Civ4Theme_Common.thm.
2. Open it in a text editor (Notepad++ or VS Code).
3. Search for .Font (around line 357) and raise the numeric sizes in the GFont(...) entries — a bump of 2 to 4 points is the range most players report as usable at 4K (e.g. 12 to 14 or 16).
4. Save and restart the game.

Watch out

The surrounding UI art does not grow with the text. Large increases make labels overflow their buttons and boxes — keep the bump modest and check every screen.

1.7.3 City name and production labels

The on-map city billboards use a fixed bitmap font that the theme edit does not touch. In `Assets\XML\Art\Civ4ArtDefines_Misc.xml`, find the `CITY_BILLBOARDS` entry and set `<fScale>` to a negative value such as `-1.0` — a negative value makes the game use the regular interface font for these labels instead.

1.7.4 When a mod is loaded

If the active mod ships its own interface theme (most total conversions do), edit that mod's `Resource\Themes\Civ4\Civ4Theme_Common.thm` rather than the base game's — otherwise the game loads the mod's theme and your base-game edit has no effect.

1.7.5 Last resort: lower the resolution

Many players simply run the game at 1440p or 1080p (windowed if needed) on a 4K monitor. The UI stays small but readable, and nothing clips. The All Mod Chooser (v2.9+) can set the game's resolution and windowed mode for you.

2 Modlist — Throne of Titans

Every entry in this list was researched on 2026-08-21 at the project owner's request, from each mod's own material — its CivFanatics thread or resource page, official site, or SourceForge page. Entries are recorded as that material states them; the project owner remains the final authority on every entry and may amend or remove any of them. Target version: Beyond the Sword 3.19, organized with the CIV 4 – All Mod Chooser.

2.1 How entries are recorded

Each mod is recorded with the four required fields: *Name* + *URL* (clickable), *Dependencies*, *System / mechanic impact* (what it changes), and *Notes* (load order, configuration, and other relevant details).

Good to know

Two kinds of install, two kinds of coexistence:

- **CustomAssets mods** (Wave 0 — BUG, BULL, Blue Marble) modify the unmodded game and load automatically. Civ 4 ignores CustomAssets while a Mods-folder mod is active, so they pair with vanilla play — not with the total conversions below.
- **Mods-folder mods** (Waves 1–3 — K-Mod, RevolutionDCM, Rhye's and Fall of Civilization, Fall from Heaven II, Realism Invictus, Rise of Mankind: A New Dawn, Caveman 2 Cosmos) each ship their own DLL and replace the game wholesale — pick exactly one per game with the mod chooser.

2.2 Wave 0 — Vanilla + UI/QoL only

Wave 0 philosophy: the game stays vanilla; only user-interface and quality-of-life mods qualify. These three install side by side into CustomAssets.

BUG Mod 4.4

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword 3.19. The official installer places the files in CustomAssets and the BUG Mod folder; the mod states it is compatible with BTS 3.19.

System / mechanic impact: UI and quality-of-life overhaul with an 'unaltered gameplay' design: no changes to unit stats, combat rules, terrain yields, or AI behavior. Upgrades the advisor screens, city screen, main map interface, and Civlopedia, and only makes information visible that a player could work out manually. Nearly every feature is toggleable from the BUG options screen (Ctrl+Alt+O).

Notes: Version 4.4. Considered safe for succession games precisely because it changes nothing mechanically. Install Blue Marble before BUG. BAT Mod 4.1 packages BUG + BULL + Blue Marble into one install — a ready-made alternative to installing them separately (thread: <https://forums.civfanatics.com/threads/bat-mod-4-1.348587/>).

BULL 1.2

Dependencies: Requires the BUG Mod; Beyond the Sword 3.19 (BTS-3.19 DLL). Download from the BULL SourceForge files page: <https://sourceforge.net/projects/civ4bull/files/BULL%20for%20BTS%203.19/>

System / mechanic impact: DLL-level companion to BUG that unlocks what a Python/XML interface cannot do on its own: a more detailed combat-odds display, extra unit commands and automation, and bug fixes that include components of the Unofficial 3.19 Patch.

Notes: Version 1.2. Install after BUG — its installer targets the BUG installation. BUFFY is a pre-packaged BUG + BULL bundle used for Hall of Fame games, if you prefer one install.

Blue Marble 4.50 Gold

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword 3.19 (the mod also states support for the base game and Warlords). Installed into CustomAssets by its installer; on the Steam version the installer can fail to find the game — a dummy civilization4.exe in the Beyond the Sword folder is the documented workaround.

System / mechanic impact: Graphics only: photorealistic terrain textures based on NASA satellite imagery, plus modernized fonts, cursors, and color scheme. No gameplay changes. The installer lets you choose components — terrain, leaderheads, interface, and more — so you can keep the original art where you prefer it.

Notes: Latest installer: v4.50 Gold. Install before BUG/BAT and re-run the installer after patching the game. Included in BAT 4.1 — do not stack a separate Blue Marble on top of BAT.

2.3 Wave 1 — New systems begin

Wave 1+ philosophy: more content and new mechanics — never pure power spikes. Both entries are Mods-folder mods: pick one per game.

K-Mod 1.46

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword 3.19, Windows only — the mod states it cannot run on the Mac version. Installed as a standalone mod in the Mods folder.

System / mechanic impact: Major AI overhaul: smarter city placement, research, military strategy, and victory pursuit, less AI 'cheating' (reduced knowledge of what is in the fog of war), more distinct leader personalities, and a notably more aggressive AI. Also integrates BUG-style interface features, faster turn times, a reworked, less punishing global warming system, and small balance buffs to weak options such as the Serfdom civic and the Protective and Aggressive traits.

Notes: Version 1.46 (May 2018). Self-contained DLL mod — it carries its own UI features, so do not run it together with BUG/BULL. Later used as the foundation for Advanced Civ. Includes Willowmound's ActualQuotes flavor text on tech discovery.

RevolutionDCM 2.90

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword 3.19. Must be installed at ...\\Beyond the Sword\\Mods\\RevolutionDCM\\ — the Revolution.ini configuration file lives there. The mod's thread recommends clearing the game cache if it does not load cleanly.

System / mechanic impact: Modpack that makes the world politically unstable: the Revolution stability system (government, civics, and city management affect stability; chronic instability can make cities revolt, break away to form independent nations, or join another civilization), BarbarianCiv (barbarian cities can settle down into full civilizations), Dale's Combat Mod, integrated Better BTS AI, DynamicCivNames, a Tech Diffusion catch-up mechanic, and AIAutoPlay / ChangePlayer tools.

Notes: Version 2.90, built for BTS 3.19. Highly modular — most components, including Better BTS AI, BUG, and the Combat Mod, can be toggled on or off from the in-game options. Install path matters for the .ini; the mod's own thread is the source for setup details.

2.4 Wave 2 — Deeper systems

Wave 1+ philosophy: more content and new mechanics — never pure power spikes. Each entry is a standalone experience: pick one per game.

Rhye's and Fall of Civilization (RFC) 1.187

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword 3.19 — digital versions are already patched; disc installs need the 3.19 patch first. Download page: <https://forums.civfanatics.com/threads/download-latest-version-here.176754/>

System / mechanic impact: Earth-history simulation: civilizations spawn on the map at their historical dates and locations, flipping cities in their core areas, and the world keeps turning whether you are there or not. A stability system can collapse unstable empires and respawn fallen ones, and every civilization has a unique Historical Victory — Egypt, for example, must control the Nile and build the Pyramids.

Notes: Version 1.187 is the final release of the original mod; the actively maintained community successor is RFC Dawn of Civilization. The RFC Atlas at rhye.civfanatics.net maps spawn dates and UHV areas and is worth keeping open while playing.

Fall from Heaven II 0.40

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword patched to 3.19. Discussion and support thread: <https://forums.civfanatics.com/threads/mod-fall-from-heaven-ii.171398/>

System / mechanic impact: Dark-fantasy total conversion set on the world of Erebus: 14 spheres of magic whose casters gain experience over time, over 20 asymmetric civilizations, religions tied to a Good/Neutral/Evil alignment system, an Apocalypse timer that tracks the world's descent into darkness, explorable lairs, hero units with criteria-gated upgrades, and 18 scenarios with storylines and unusual victory conditions in the final release.

Notes: Final version 0.40 released 16 December 2008 with the scenario suite; the team's later patches extended it into the 0.41 series, which most community installs use. Developed by a team led by Derek 'Kael' Paxton. Community continuations include Ashes of Erebus and Master of Mana.

Realism Invictus

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword 3.19. Ships in Full, Light, and Unpacked variants — Unpacked is recommended on modern systems to mitigate memory-related crashes.

System / mechanic impact: Realism overhaul with over 130 technologies: a reworked military where unit composition matters and 'stacks of doom' are penalized, a resource hierarchy that demands long-term planning and trade, a harsher early economy where overexpansion can cripple you, barbarians that evolve into civilizations if left unchecked, and religions that each play differently and drive conflict.

Notes: Roughly two decades of development, originating from Total Realism. Version 3.6 (December 2022) is stable; 3.8 / 3.81 are the current releases at the time of writing. Downloads: Full and Light versions on CivFanatics resources, Unpacked version alongside.

Rise of Mankind: A New Dawn (AND)

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword 3.19. Standalone mod built on Rise of Mankind by Zappara and expanded by Afforess; downloaded from SourceForge: <https://sourceforge.net/projects/anewdawn/files/>

System / mechanic impact: Modular expansion of Rise of Mankind: almost every new feature can be toggled on or off, a vastly expanded tech tree that reaches into the future, a stronger AI, a Revolutions stability system, a reworked diplomacy system with embassies and trading contacts, a large pool of new units, buildings, and wonders, and extensive automation options to manage the added complexity.

Notes: Current release: A New Dawn 2 (full installer revision 1093, January 2022, ~1.1 GB). Maintained by the AND Resurrection Team. Official feature list at anewdawn.sourceforge.io.

2.5 Wave 3 — The Throne of Titans

Wave 1+ philosophy: more content and new mechanics — never pure power spikes. Wave 3 holds a single total conversion — pick it when you are ready for the long game.

Caveman 2 Cosmos

Dependencies: Beyond the Sword 3.19 (official requirement). Suggested specs from the thread: 64-bit ~2.6 GHz CPU, 4 GB RAM (3 minimum), 10 GB+ free space (60 GB recommended), 1 GB graphics card. English-only.

System / mechanic impact: Total conversion — the thread calls it 'the most expansive Civilization 4: BTS mod to date'. 734+ technologies with a new tech tree (incl. Space Era); gameplay spans Prehistoric to Galactic eras; a single game can take 100+ hours. Built on a Rise of Mankind (RoM 2.2) base with merged content such as RevolutionDCM and unit art from Diversica / Varietas Delectat; developed by StrategyOnly Productions with 100+ credited modders.

Notes: Version 43 (15 Jan 2023) at the time of writing. Save-game compatible across C2C versions — when asked, accept the modifier recalculation. 'Graphics paging' option in the BUG Options screen saves ~30% RAM and reduces MAF errors; frequent SVN/daily updates. Download: <https://forums.civfanatics.com/resources/caveman2cosmos.15324/> — see the thread's FAQ (post #11) for known issues and workarounds.

3 Wave 0 — The First Flame

Your first game of Civilization IV: Beyond the Sword — how to set it up, what you are looking at, and what to do. All vanilla BTS 3.19.

3.1 The Story

The Story

The night was cold and the tribe was small. When the first spark caught in the dry grass, the circle of faces fell silent — here was light that did not flee and warmth that did not die. They fed it with sticks and swore never to let it go out. Where the river bent and the hills stood guard, they raised their first huts around the fire. The smoke climbed over a settlement without a name, but it would earn one. Every city you will ever build begins the same way: with one flame, held against the dark.

3.2 Game Setup

For your first game, choose **Custom Game** from the single-player menu and set:

- **Difficulty: Settler** — the easiest level: slow rivals, cheap mistakes. Pick **Chieftain** for more pushback.
- **Map: Continents, size Small** — a few landmasses and a handful of rivals.
- **Speed: Normal** — the default pace, so this guide matches your screen.
- Leave every other option at its default; if wandering barbarians feel like too much, switch them **Off** for the first game.

Good to know

Choose a leader with the **Financial** trait — for example **Roosevelt** of America or **Isabella** of Spain. Financial earns extra gold from rich tiles, which quietly smooths over beginner mistakes.

3.3 What Kind of Game Is This

Civilization is a turn-based empire-building game. You start in 4000 BC with one settlement and one exploring unit, and play until someone wins. On your turn you decide what each city builds, where units move, what your people research, and how you treat the civilizations you meet. Then you press end turn and the world moves: rivals act, barbarians stir, events happen — and control returns to you. Nothing proceeds without your say-so, and that is the appeal: your empire is a machine you assemble one decision at a time. Several paths lead to victory, from conquest to culture to science.

3.4 The Screen at a Glance

The map fills the screen, with your units standing on tiles. Around it:

- **The main map** — tiles show terrain, resources, and improvements. Click a unit to select it; right-click a tile to move it there.

- **The city list** — on the left, each city with its build and growth. Click a city to open its screen.
- **The top bar** — four sliders: research (beakers), gold, culture, and espionage, plus your treasury and the date.
- **The minimap** — a tiny view of the world; click it to jump the camera.
- **The end-turn button** — press it when your turn is done.

Tip

Before you press end turn, glance at the city list — a finished build or a full food box means a decision is waiting. A few seconds of checking keeps nothing idle.

3.5 Your First City

Your starting settler founds your capital. The two numbers that matter in the city screen are **food** and **production** (hammers). Food grows the population: when the food box fills, the city gains a citizen, who works a tile and adds its yields. Production builds things, one hammer at a time.

Your first build should be a **warrior** if you have no defender yet, or a **work boat** if the capital is on the coast. Then build a **worker** — improvements are the engine of the early game — and after that a **settler** for your second city. Two rules: never let the city sit idle, and never send your only defender far from home.

3.6 Workers and Improvements

Workers build **improvements** on the tiles your citizens work:

- **Farm** — extra food, best on grassland and flood plains beside fresh water.
- **Mine** — extra production. Best on hills.
- **Cottage** — extra commerce (gold and research). It grows over time into a hamlet, village, and town, so build early and leave it alone.
- **Road** — faster movement and connections to your capital; connect your first resource as soon as you can.

Build what the land offers: food-rich ground wants farms and cottages, hill country wants mines.

3.7 Research

Research is how your empire advances. You pick one technology at a time on the **tech tree**, and your research slider turns commerce into **beakers**. Keep the slider high — 90% or 100% when the treasury allows.

A simple first path: **Agriculture** or **Mining**, whichever the land needs; then **Pottery** for granaries and cottages; then **Writing** for libraries. After that, **Animal Husbandry** if livestock or horses are near, or **Bronze Working** if you have copper or forests to clear. One goal at a time.

Tip

If the treasury runs low, dip the science slider for a few turns, then push it back up. Accept that research takes time.

3.8 Units and Combat Basics

Every unit has a **strength** value, and combat compares attacker against defender with bonuses applied. Terrain matters: defending on a hill, in a forest, or across a river grants large bonuses, so fight from good positions. Units that survive combat earn experience and **promotions** — pick ones that suit the job, like extra strength for attackers or city defense for garrison troops. Keep a few strong units in every city; an empty city is a tempting target. And never attack with outdated units: when you can build stronger, upgrade or replace.

Watch out

When the game warns that enemy units are near a city, take it seriously: hunker down, build defenders, and fight on your own ground.

3.9 Happiness and Health

Every city has a **happiness** limit and a **health** limit. Unhappy citizens refuse to work, and unhealthy ones can die — either way you lose output. The fixes: **luxury resources** like wine, silk, or gems improve happiness once connected; temples and colosseums add happiness; granaries and aqueducts improve health. And if a build cannot wait, the **whip** — the Slavery civic, unlocked by Bronze Working — converts population into production, at the cost of some grumbling.

3.10 Economy

The economy is what your cities produce in **commerce**, the third yield after food and production. Commerce flows through the top-bar sliders and becomes beakers (research) and gold (your treasury); the **science slider** sets the split. Cottages are your early commerce engine; **specialists** — citizens assigned jobs like scientist or priest — matter later, once buildings support them. The short version: grow food, work cottages, keep the science slider high.

3.11 Culture and Borders

Borders are set by **culture**. Cities produce it from buildings — a monument is the cheapest early source — and from wonders. As culture accumulates, a city's borders grow through four levels, claiming more tiles and resources. Culture also presses on neighbors: a border city with lots of it can flip tiles, even foreign cities, toward you. Build a monument early in every new city.

3.12 Religion

Religions are **founded** by researching their tech first: **Buddhism** from Meditation, **Hinduism** from Polytheism, **Judaism** from Monotheism, and later Confucianism, Taoism, Christianity, and Islam. The founding city becomes the religion's **holy city**. Religions spread between cities, your own and foreign ones, and each city with a faith can build its temple and missionaries. Adopting a **state religion** makes cities with that faith happier and lets you spread it, at the price of annoying neighbors who follow other gods. You never must found one; if one spreads to you, enjoy it.

3.13 Diplomacy

When you meet another civilization, the diplomacy screen opens a conversation: trade resources and technologies, sign open borders, declare war or make peace, and — late in the game — **defensive pacts**, where two nations pledge to defend each other. Beginner basics: trade away surplus resources — an extra one earns nothing sitting idle — and keep at least one friendly neighbor. The other leaders have long memories.

3.14 Victory Types

- **Conquest** — capture every rival's original capital.
- **Domination** — own a large majority of the world's land and population.
- **Cultural** — raise three cities to legendary culture (50,000 culture each).
- **Space Race** — build the spaceship to Alpha Centauri first.
- **Diplomatic** — win a vote in the United Nations.
- **Time** — if nobody wins by 2050, the highest score takes it.

3.15 Common Beginner Mistakes

- Letting cities sit idle — always have a build queued, even a cheap one.
- Sending your only defender to explore — garrison the city; explore with a spare unit.
- Building improvements the land does not want — build what the terrain offers.
- Ignoring happiness and health until cities stop growing — check the city screen and fix the cause.
- Attacking with outdated units — build or upgrade something stronger first.
- Running the treasury dry — keep a small gold buffer; dip the science slider when needed.
- Trading away resources you need — only trade your surplus.

3.16 Mods for this wave

Wave 0 mods: *BUG Mod 4.4*, *BULL 1.2*, *Blue Marble 4.50 Gold* — full entries in the Modlist chapter.

4 Wave 1 — The Rising Realm

4.1 The Story

The Story

Far from the great powers, a young kingdom stirs within its river valley. Fields are cleared, roads are laid, and the first walls rise on the hilltops. Word arrives of empty lands to the north — rich soil, iron, a strait worth holding. The king calls his council: who will carry the banner beyond the old borders? Farmers become soldiers, hunters scouts, and the first war parties march out singing. The realm is waking, and the world will learn its name.

4.2 Game Setup

Play on **Noble**: the AI fights without significant bonuses, so early mistakes cost a city, not the game. Choose **Continents** or **Fractal** at **Standard** size — both leave room to expand — at **Normal** speed, which gives every era time to teach its lessons.

Pick a **Financial** or **Expansive** leader: Financial adds commerce to coastal tiles and cottages, Expansive grants health and faster workers. Pacal of the Maya has both, and his Holkan needs no metal — a safe city on any map.

4.3 Economy Foundations

The science slider **is** your economy. Run it high, but never bleed gold: when the treasury empties, drop to 0%, bank the gold, then spend it on a full-speed run at the key tech.

Watch out

The classic mistake: 100% research with an empty treasury. Decide which tech matters next, save at 0%, then flip to 100% and finish it in a burst — banked gold buys research at full strength instead of dribbling at 60%.

Grow cities two ways: **cottages** that mature into villages and towns (best long-term, boosted by Financial), and **specialists** in farm-rich cities — scientists push research and generate Great People. Cottage your commerce cities; specialize your food cities.

Research in lines, not hops: beeline the prizes — Writing for libraries, Alphabet for trading, Currency for wealth — but never skip worker techs like Agriculture, Mining, and Bronze Working; improved tiles outpace any single tech.

4.4 Early Expansion

Build your first settler once the capital reaches size 3 or 4, after a worker or two — an idle second city helps no one. Scout ahead so every settler has a destination.

Choose city sites with care:

- **Resources**: a food bonus such as corn or pigs pays back the settler fast.
- **Fresh water**: riverside and lake cities get a health bonus now and irrigation later.
- **Hills**: a hilly city builds units and wonders much faster.
- **Chokepoints**: a narrow strip between water and hills keeps enemies out of your backfield.

A good target for this wave is **four to eight cities**. Each one raises maintenance — distance plus city count — so pace your settlers and rush a courthouse for far-away sites. If gold per turn goes red, stop expanding and grow what you have.

Tip

Slavery (from Bronze Working) is this wave's best-kept secret: a size-4 city can **whip** a settler or worker in a few turns. Grow it back while the new city comes online — that is how strong players expand twice as fast.

4.5 Your First Wars

Strike when you have an edge. If a neighbor has no copper or iron, your axes and swords face mere archers — that is the moment to march. Otherwise, wait for catapults and a real troop lead. Keep your units in **one stack**: a dozen together take cities ten solo raids never would.

Siege first, always: catapults bombard the walls, then attack in waves. Collateral damage softens the garrison, and promoted axes and swords sweep the survivors. Keep good captured cities; raze only worthless ones.

In the peace deal, demand **techs and gold** — a captured city plus Alphabet is a fine ending. Do not chase them to their last city while the treasury bleeds.

Good to know

War weariness mounts every turn you fight and drags down happiness at home. That is why short wars beat long ones: take your objective, take your peace deal, and spend the next era building — not marching.

4.6 Diplomacy

Trade, but watch what you give. Swap spare horses or gems for the happiness and health you lack — happy faces let cities grow, healthy ones faster. Trade techs only once you have stopped needing them; never hand a neighbor a weapon to use against you.

Open borders with everyone early: trade routes add gold to every connected city, and your scouts tour foreign lands free. Close them if a warlike neighbor camps a stack at your door.

The best war is the one that never starts. Stay at rough military parity so the AI sees no soft target, trade fairly, and answer requests you can afford. A friendly neighbor is a steady source of gold, techs, and peace of mind.

4.7 Mods for this wave

Wave 1 mods: *K-Mod 1.46*, *RevolutionDCM 2.90* — full entries in the *Modlist* chapter.

5 Wave 2 — The Gilded Age

5.1 The Story

The Story

Bells rang over the gilded capital as merchant caravans filed through the gates, and the guild halls filled with talk of new corporations and foreign gold. In the temple quarter, masons raised the last of the great cathedrals, their spires catching the evening light. Beneath the city, however, another trade was being plied — a veiled figure slipped past the watch, a scroll of siege plans tucked inside her cloak, and the spymaster smiled at how cheaply a rival's secrets could be bought.

5.2 Game Setup

Step up to **Prince** if you have not already, and aim for **Monarch** once you are comfortable. Play **Continents** or **Fractal** on a **Standard** or **Large** map — both give you room to build a tall heartland and then push outward. Keep **Normal** or **Epic** speed; either suits this stage, and Epic gives your newer mid-game units more time to matter.

5.3 Corporations

Corporations are BTS's answer to a late-game economy: you found one by spending a **Great Person** together with a specific technology, then spread it with **executives** — special units that, like missionaries, carry the corporation into cities. Headquarters cities collect gold from every branch, including foreign ones, and each corporation converts different resources into different yields: some turn grain into food, others turn metals into production.

Tip

Read each corporation's Civlopedia entry before you commit a Great Person — the resource mix and yield type decide everything about where it earns.

Founding early is generally wise, since a corporation compounds across every city it reaches. If your empire runs on food, favor a food-generating corporation; if you are rich in metals, the industrial ones pay off faster. Either way, expect foreign branches to fund your capital handsomely.

5.4 Espionage

Spies unlock a quiet arsenal of missions: **steal technology**, **poison water**, **revolt city**, **sabotage production**, and more. Every mission costs espionage points, which you accumulate with the **espionage slider** — a share of your commerce turned into points — and through spy specialists. The **weighting** in the espionage screen splits your points between rivals; weight a dangerous neighbor heavily, and both your missions and your passive detection of their plots improve.

Watch out

Espionage is a slow investment. A stolen tech is wonderful, but the same slider could have bought you the tech in beakers — spend points where the target is far ahead, not on parity rivals.

5.5 Religion and Culture

A state religion rewards you with faster construction of temples, monasteries, and cathedrals, and your holy city collects gold from every city that follows the faith. The **cultural victory** path leans on these buildings: three cities pushed to **legendary** status, fed by cathedrals, great artists, and culture-producing specialists.

The religion civics ask for a tradeoff. **Organized Religion** speeds building but demands a state religion; **Theocracy** trains better units but blocks missionaries; **Free Religion** gives +10% science in every city — the classic choice once your cathedrals are built.

5.6 Civics

Civics come in five categories — **Government**, **Legal**, **Labor**, **Economy**, and **Religion** — and each switch costs a turn of anarchy, so bundle several changes into one switch when you can. **Spiritual** leaders skip anarchy entirely and can experiment freely.

On labor, weigh **Slavery** against **Caste System**. Slavery converts citizens into instant production — perfect for rushing a wonder or a defensive army — while Caste System replaces whipping with unlimited specialists, which feeds great people and research. Most games run Slavery through the mid-game and switch to Caste System once the big wonders are done.

5.7 Great People and Golden Ages

Great person farms concentrate specialists — scientists and priests first, merchants and artists later — in a few food-rich cities with the right buildings, and the National Epic doubles their output there. Bank great people until you can spend two at once for a **golden age**: a burst of +100% to production, commerce, and research that also ends your anarchy if you time it with a civic switch.

Good to know

A golden age also refreshes your great person progress — trigger it just after a great person is born, never right before one.

5.8 Mid-Game Warfare

Build **counter units**, not just hammers: pikemen stop mounted, macemen and crossbowmen rule the field until gunpowder. Siege is how you take cities — catapults and trebuchets soften defenses and wound stacks, so bring plenty and protect them. Promote **veterans** instead of building fresh units: every survivor with a combat promotion beats a replacement, and upgrading them with gold later preserves their experience.

Tip

Withdraw your wounded veterans to heal rather than grinding them down; an experienced core that survives wave after wave becomes unstoppable when you reach cuirassiers and riflemen.

5.9 Mods for this wave

Wave 2 mods: Rhye's and Fall of Civilization, Fall from Heaven II, Realism Invictus, Rise of Mankind: A New Dawn — full entries in the Modlist chapter.

6 Wave 3 — The Throne of Titans

6.1 The Story

The Story

The old empires have fallen, and the great powers that remain are of a different order — titans girded for a contest that ends only when one rules the world. Every alliance is a lie waiting for the right moment, every border a battlefield waiting for the right general. The throne is empty. The world watches to see who will take it.

6.2 Game Setup

Monarch is the sandbox, Immortal is the proving ground, Deity for the brave. Continents, Fractal, and Pangaea all work — pick your favorite shape. Standard to Large maps give titans room; Epic or Marathon speed stretches the game into a long campaign. Above all, play ironman: no reloads, no second chances. The throne belongs to whoever wins with the hand they are dealt.

6.3 Victory Race Management

Commit to one victory type early and let every later decision serve it — and deny rivals theirs: a diplomatic win dies when you hold the largest population and keep rivals from the Secretary General's seat at the United Nations and the Resident's at the Apostolic Palace; a cultural win dies when one of the three legendary cities is taken before the culture completes. A rival allowed two open victory tracks will take one.

Watch out

At the United Nations, only the Secretary General wins a diplomatic victory, and only with a majority of the population-weighted votes cast. Keep your population on top and rival friendships short.

6.4 Advanced Warfare

Modern war is won from the air and sea before a soldier marches. Fighters win the sky and intercept enemy bombers; bombers and later stealth bombers flatten cities; carriers project it across oceans. A naval blockade cuts a rival's trade routes and starves their gold. Nuclear weapons end wars in a turn, but the Manhattan Project announces your intent and every launch poisons world opinion — expect broken alliances and a united front. The kinder sword is vassalage: batter a foe until they capitulate — their land and population count toward domination while they fight your wars.

Good to know

Tactical nukes are cheaper and launch from ships; ICBMs reach any tile. Both carry the same diplomatic fallout — once you use them, you own the aftermath.

6.5 Economy at Scale

Trailing in tech is a position, not a fate. Trade what you have for what you lack, run a spy economy to steal whole branches from the leaders, and bulb the rest with great scientists. Open borders with everyone who will sign, and let foreign trade routes carry your commerce. In the corporation endgame, Sid's Sushi Co feeds cities and adds culture, Mining Inc turns coal and iron into hammers, and Aluminum Co secures the resource. Keep the great people flowing: settle some, bulb some, and hold pairs for golden ages.

6.6 Micromanagement

The last ten percent of difficulty lives in the details. Reassign tiles by hand whenever a city grows — the governor's defaults serve no plan. Then choose the specialists: scientists in science cities, engineers in production cities, merchants in commerce cities. Time wonders to land during a golden age so doubled production applies to the whole build, and chain golden ages back to back when you have the people for it.

Tip

Whipping converts population into hammers immediately — thirty per citizen at Normal speed, more on slower speeds — at the cost of one unhappy citizen per whipped pop for ten turns. Worth it whenever that building or unit matters more than the anger; never worth it when it stalls a city's growth curve.

6.7 City Specialization

Every city earns one label and one job. A science city stacks libraries and universities and runs scientists. A production city works every mine and runs engineers, building the army for everyone. A great person farm piles on national wonders like the National Epic and runs as many specialists as food allows. A commerce city works cottages, then a market and a bank, and finances the empire. Cities that do all of this do all of it badly.

6.8 Endgame Diplomacy

The endgame is a courtroom as much as a battlefield. Once defensive pacts unlock, sign one with a partner who likes you — an attack on either of you is a war on both. At the United Nations, votes are population, so keep yours highest and vote down resolutions that could crown a rival. At the Apostolic Palace, watch who built it and in which holy city, then weigh the religion's influence against its resident. And watch the scoreboard: a rival pulling ahead on land, population, and wonders is climbing toward your throne.

6.9 Mods for this wave

Wave 3 mod: *Caveman 2 Cosmos* — the full entry is in the Modlist chapter.

7 Glossary

Every term, abbreviation, and piece of shorthand in this guide, in plain words — from BFC to Ziggurat. Vanilla Beyond the Sword, patch 3.19.

7.1 A

- **Aggressive:** Trait granting free Combat I to melee and gunpowder units, with faster barracks.
- **Agriculture:** Early technology unlocking farms, the foundation of food and growth.
- **Alphabet:** Technology unlocking tech trading and the Research build; in Beyond the Sword, spies too.
- **Anarchy:** Turns of no output when changing civics or state religion.
- **Apostolic Palace:** Beyond the Sword world project, unlocked by Theology, that lets followers of its religion vote on resolutions and on diplomatic victory.
- **Archer:** Early defender with bonuses in cities and on hills.
- **Archipelago:** Map type of many small islands where naval power rules.

7.2 B

- **Beakers:** Research points; commerce becomes beakers through the science slider.
- **BFC:** Big Fat Cross — the 21 tiles a city can work.
- **Bronze Working:** Early technology unlocking the Slavery civic, axemen, and forest chopping.
- **Buddhism:** Religion founded by the first to research the Buddhism technology.
- **Bureaucracy:** Legal civic granting +50% commerce and +50% production in the capital.

7.3 C

- **Capitulation:** Ending a losing war by accepting vassalage to the victor.
- **Caste System:** Labor civic allowing unlimited artist, merchant, and scientist specialists.
- **Charismatic:** Trait granting +1 happiness per city and cheaper promotions.
- **Civic:** A policy chosen from one of five categories: Government, Legal, Labor, Economy, and Religion.
- **Civil Service:** Technology unlocking Bureaucracy and letting farms chain irrigation.
- **Code of Laws:** Technology founding Confucianism and unlocking courthouses and Caste System.
- **Colony:** Releasing distant overseas cities as an autonomous state, friendly to its motherland.
- **Commerce:** City income, divided among research, culture, and gold.
- **Conquest:** Victory by capturing every rival's original capital.
- **Continents:** Map type with several large landmasses separated by ocean.
- **Corporation:** Economic institution founded by a great person, spread by executives, that consumes resources for bonuses.
- **Cottage:** Commerce improvement that grows through hamlet, village, and town stages.
- **Creative:** Trait granting +2 culture per city and faster libraries and theaters.
- **Cultural victory:** Victory by raising three cities to legendary culture.
- **Culture:** City output that expands borders, presses on neighbors, and feeds cultural victory.
- **Currency:** Technology adding +1 trade route per city and enabling Wealth.

7.4 D

- **Deity:** The hardest difficulty level, where rivals enjoy large bonuses.
- **Diplomatic victory:** Winning a United Nations or Apostolic Palace vote.
- **Domination:** Victory by owning a large majority of the world's land and population.

7.5 E

- **Emancipation:** Labor civic that doubles cottage growth and stirs unhappiness in empires that do not adopt it.
- **Environmentalism:** Economy civic granting +6 health, with forests, jungles, windmills, and forest preserves adding bonuses.
- **Espionage:** The Beyond the Sword spy system: points gathered to fund missions against rival civilizations.
- **Executive:** Unit that spreads a corporation to foreign cities.
- **Expansive:** Trait granting +2 health per city and faster granaries and harbors.

7.6 F

- **Farm:** Improvement providing food, best beside fresh water.
- **Feudalism:** Technology unlocking longbows and the Vassalage civic.
- **Financial:** Trait granting +1 commerce on tiles with at least two commerce.
- **Food:** Yield that grows cities; food resources also add small health bonuses.
- **Forest preserve:** Beyond the Sword improvement that keeps forests for science and health.
- **Fort:** Improvement, unlocked by Mathematics, that defends like a city and connects resources.
- **Fractal:** Map type with organic, unpredictable coastlines.
- **Free Market:** Economy civic granting +1 trade route in every city.
- **Free Speech:** Legal civic granting +2 commerce from every town and +100% culture in all cities.

7.7 G

- **Gandhi:** Indian leader with the Spiritual and Philosophical traits.
- **Golden Age:** Eight turns of +1 hammer and +1 commerce on worked tiles, double great person points, and no anarchy.
- **Great Artist:** Great person that adds culture to a city and can perform a culture bomb.

- **Great Engineer:** Great person that rushes production or boosts a city's output.
- **Great General:** Unit born from military victories that can attach to an army as an instructor or found a Military Academy.
- **Great Merchant:** Great person that runs a trade mission for gold or builds a Customs House.
- **Great Person Points:** Accumulated points that birth great people; each birth raises the next threshold.
- **Great Prophet:** Great person that builds a shrine in the holy city.
- **Great Scientist:** Great person that builds an Academy or discovers a technology.
- **Great Spy:** Great person that strengthens espionage or infiltrates a rival civilization.

7.8 H

- **Hamlet:** The second growth stage of a cottage.
- **Hammers:** Production yield, spent to build units, buildings, and wonders.
- **Hereditary Rule:** Government civic granting +1 happiness per military unit stationed in a city.
- **Hinduism:** Religion founded by the first to research the Hinduism technology.
- **Holy city:** The city where a religion was founded, home of its shrine.

7.9 I

- **Immortal:** Persian unique unit replacing the Chariot.
- **Imperialistic:** Trait granting faster settlers and more Great Generals.
- **Industrious:** Trait granting +50% wonder production and faster forges.
- **Iron:** Strategic resource that unlocks swordsmen and later military units.
- **Islam:** Religion founded with Divine Right.
- **Ivory:** Luxury resource granting happiness and enabling war elephants.

7.10 J

- **Judaism:** Religion founded by the first to research Monotheism.
- **Jungle:** Dense vegetation blocking improvements until workers clear it.

7.11 L

- **Liberalism:** Technology granting a free technology to its first discoverer.
- **Luxury resource:** Gold, silver, gems, fur, ivory, silk, spice, sugar, wine, incense, and dye — connected luxuries grant happiness.

7.12 M

- **Marathon:** The longest game speed, 1500 turns.
- **Mass Media:** Technology unlocking the United Nations and broadcast towers.
- **Mathematics:** Technology unlocking catapults and forts, with better forest chopping.
- **Mercantilism:** Economy civic granting a free specialist per city at the cost of foreign trade routes.
- **Mine:** Improvement adding production, best on hills.
- **Mining:** Early technology unlocking mines for hills.
- **Monarch:** A high difficulty level, demanding solid play.

7.13 N

- **Noble:** The default difficulty level, with no bonuses either way.
- **Normal:** The standard game speed, 500 turns.

7.14 O

- **Obelisk:** Egyptian unique building replacing the Monument.
- **Oil:** Strategic resource powering modern units and buildings.
- **Open Borders:** Diplomatic agreement allowing free passage and foreign trade routes.
- **Organized:** Trait halving civic upkeep and speeding courthouses and factories.
- **Organized Religion:** Religion civic granting +25% building production in cities following your state religion.

7.15 P

- **Pacifism:** Religion civic doubling great person points, at the cost of gold upkeep per military unit.
- **Pangaea:** Map type with one giant supercontinent.

- **Philosophical:** Trait doubling great person point production.
- **Philosophy:** Technology founding Taoism and unlocking Pacifism.
- **Plantation:** Improvement for luxury crops such as sugar, wine, and silk.
- **Praetorian:** Roman unique unit replacing the Swordsman.
- **Printing Press:** Technology adding commerce to villages and towns.
- **Protective:** Trait granting free defensive promotions to archery and gunpowder units.

7.16 Q

- **Quick:** The fastest game speed, 250 turns.

7.17 R

- **Railroad:** Improvement and technology speeding land movement and linking resources.
- **Random event:** Unexpected Beyond the Sword occurrence, from forest fires to merchant windfalls.
- **Redcoat:** English unique unit replacing the Rifleman.
- **Representation:** Government civic giving specialists +3 research and happiness in the largest cities.
- **Rifling:** Technology unlocking riflemen and cavalry.
- **Road:** Improvement speeding movement and connecting resources.

7.18 S

- **Sabotage Production:** Espionage mission that destroys a rival's unfinished build.
- **Settler:** Unit that founds new cities.
- **Sid's Sushi Co.:** Corporation founded by a Great Merchant, turning seafood into food and culture.
- **Slavery:** Labor civic that lets cities sacrifice population to hurry production.
- **Space race:** Victory by completing the spaceship to Alpha Centauri first.
- **Specialists:** Citizens assigned roles such as scientist, merchant, or spy, producing yields and great person points.
- **Spiritual:** Trait allowing civic and religion changes without anarchy.
- **Spy:** Stealth unit that runs espionage missions.
- **Standard Ethanol:** Corporation founded by a Great Scientist, converting crops into production.
- **State Property:** Economy civic removing distance maintenance and disabling corporations, with +10% production everywhere.
- **State religion:** The faith an empire officially follows, boosting cities that share it.
- **Strategic resource:** Iron, copper, horses, stone, marble, coal, oil, uranium, and aluminum — resources needed for key units and buildings.

7.19 T

- **Taoism:** Religion founded by the first to research Philosophy.
- **Theocracy:** Religion civic granting new units +2 experience while blocking other faiths from spreading.
- **Theology:** Technology founding Christianity and unlocking the Apostolic Palace.
- **Time victory:** If no one wins by 2050, the highest score takes the game.
- **Town:** The final cottage stage, richest in commerce.
- **Traits:** Leader characteristics granting permanent empire-wide bonuses.

7.20 U

- **Unique building:** A civilization's replacement for a standard building, with an edge.
- **Unique unit:** A civilization's replacement for a standard unit, with an edge.
- **United Nations:** World project unlocked by Mass Media, hosting votes on resolutions and diplomatic victory.
- **Universal Suffrage:** Government civic that lets cities buy production with gold and adds +1 hammer to towns.

7.21 V

- **Vassal:** A civilization under another's protection, sharing part of its research and gold.
- **Vassalage:** Legal civic granting new units +2 experience and extra free units.
- **Village:** The third growth stage of a cottage.

7.22 W

- **War elephant:** Mounted unit requiring ivory, powerful in the classical era.
- **Watermill:** Riverside improvement providing food and production.
- **Windmill:** Hill improvement providing commerce, and food in later eras.
- **Workshop:** Improvement trading food for production.
- **Writing:** Technology unlocking libraries and scholarship.

7.23 Z

- **Ziggurat:** Sumerian unique building replacing the Courthouse.